

Business Process Document

Order to Delivery & Claim and Returns Processes

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1. Order to Delivery Business Process

1.1 Overview

The order-to-delivery process in an automotive spare parts ordering system covers the complete lifecycle of a parts order, starting from the moment a service partner or dealer identifies a need for a spare part, through the ordering, processing, dispatch, and final delivery stages. This document describes each stage in detail so that all stakeholders understand their responsibilities and what to expect at each point in the process.

1.2 Identifying the Need for a Part

The process begins when a workshop technician, service advisor, or parts manager identifies that a specific spare part is required. This could be triggered by a vehicle coming in for repair, a scheduled maintenance job, or a proactive stock replenishment decision. The person responsible for parts ordering will typically search the parts catalog using a part number, description, or vehicle identification details to confirm the correct part is being ordered. It is important at this stage to verify the part number carefully, as ordering an incorrect part leads to delays and unnecessary return processing.

1.3 Checking Availability and Pricing

Once the correct part has been identified, the ordering system allows the user to check current stock availability across different warehouses or distribution centers. The system displays available quantities, expected lead times, and current pricing including any applicable discounts or contract pricing. If a part is not available in the primary warehouse, the system may suggest alternative sourcing locations or indicate an expected restocking date. In some cases, a replacement part may be suggested if the original part has been superseded by a newer version.

1.4 Placing the Order

After confirming availability and pricing, the user proceeds to place the order. The system requires the user to specify the quantity required and confirm the delivery address. Before the order is submitted, the system performs a credit limit check to ensure the ordering account has sufficient credit to cover the order value. If the credit limit is not sufficient, the system will prevent the order from being submitted and display a notification advising the user to contact their account manager or reduce the order quantity. Once the credit check passes, the user reviews the order summary and confirms submission. The system assigns a unique order reference number at this point, which can be used for all future tracking and communication related to that order.

1.5 Order Processing at the Warehouse

Once an order is submitted, it enters the warehouse processing queue. The warehouse team receives the order and begins picking the required parts from stock. During this stage the order status in the system will reflect that it is being processed. If any part of the order cannot be fulfilled immediately due to stock discrepancies or damage found during picking, the warehouse team will update the order accordingly and the system will notify the ordering party of any partial fulfillment or backlog items.

1.6 Dispatch and Shipment

When all available items in the order have been picked and packed, the order is handed over to the logistics team for dispatch. The system records the dispatch date and assigns a shipment tracking reference. The ordering party can view this information in the order tracking section of the portal. Depending on the delivery method selected at the time of ordering, the shipment may be sent via standard courier, express delivery, or collected directly from the warehouse. The estimated delivery date is calculated based on the dispatch date and the selected delivery method.

1.7 Delivery and Confirmation

Upon delivery, the receiving party at the workshop or dealership should inspect the delivered items against the packing list to confirm that all ordered parts have been received in good condition. If there are any discrepancies, such as missing items, damaged parts, or incorrect parts delivered, these should be reported through the claims or returns process as soon as possible. The system allows the user to view the delivery status and confirm receipt. Once delivery is confirmed, the order moves to a completed status and the billing process is initiated.

1.8 Backlog and Partial Deliveries

In situations where not all ordered parts are available at the time of dispatch, the system creates a backlog entry for the outstanding items. The user can monitor the backlog through the delivery backlog section of the portal. Backlog items are fulfilled as soon as stock becomes available and are dispatched separately. The user will receive a separate shipment notification for backlog deliveries. It is important to monitor backlog items regularly, especially for urgent repair jobs, so that alternative sourcing can be arranged if the wait time is unacceptable.

1.9 Handling Unit Monitoring

For larger orders or consolidated shipments, the system provides handling unit monitoring functionality. A handling unit represents a physical package or pallet that contains one or more order items. Each handling unit is assigned a unique identifier that can be scanned and tracked throughout the logistics chain. The handling unit monitor allows users to see exactly which items are contained in each package and where that package is in the delivery process. This is particularly useful for high-value orders or when multiple orders are consolidated into a single shipment.

1.10 Order Completion and Billing

Once all items in an order have been delivered and confirmed, the order is marked as complete and the billing process begins. An invoice is generated based on the delivered quantities and agreed pricing. The invoice is made available in the billing section of the portal and can be downloaded or printed. Payment terms are as agreed in the service partner or dealer contract. Any discrepancies between the invoice and the delivered items should be raised through the claims process promptly.

2. Claim and Returns Business Process

2.1 Overview

The claim and returns process covers all scenarios where a service partner or dealer needs to report an issue with a delivered part, request a warranty reimbursement, or return parts that are no longer needed. This process is critical to maintaining trust between the parts supplier and the dealer network, and it ensures that financial adjustments are handled in a controlled and auditable manner. There are several types of claims and returns handled by the system, each with its own procedure and eligibility criteria.

2.2 Types of Claims and Returns

The system supports several distinct types of claims. A warranty claim is raised when a part has failed within its warranty period and the dealer is seeking reimbursement for the cost of the part and associated labor. A damage claim is raised when a part arrives in a damaged condition and the dealer needs a replacement or credit. A quantity discrepancy claim is raised when the number of parts delivered does not match the number invoiced. A quarterly return is a scheduled process where dealers return unsold or excess stock at the end of a quarter. A yearly return is a similar process conducted annually, typically with different eligibility rules and higher return limits.

2.3 Initiating a Warranty Claim

To initiate a warranty claim, the service partner or dealer must first confirm that the failed part is within its warranty period. The warranty period is defined by the part category and the date of original purchase. The user navigates to the claim declaration section of the portal and selects the option to create a new warranty claim. The user is required to enter the original order reference number, the part number, the quantity being claimed, and a description of the failure. Supporting documentation such as a workshop job card, photographs of the failed part, or a technical report may be required depending on the claim value and part category. Once all required information has been entered, the user submits the claim and the system assigns a unique claim reference number.

2.4 Claim Review and Approval

Once a claim is submitted, it enters a review queue where it is assessed by the claims processing team. The reviewer checks that the part is within warranty, that the failure description is consistent with a warranty-eligible defect, and that all required documentation has been provided. If additional information is needed, the reviewer will send a request back to the submitting dealer through the system, and the claim status will change to indicate that it is awaiting additional information. The dealer must respond within the specified timeframe, otherwise the claim may be closed without resolution. If the claim is approved, a credit note is issued to the dealer account. If the claim is rejected, the system records the rejection reason and the dealer is notified.

2.5 Damage Claims

A damage claim should be raised as soon as possible after delivery, ideally within the timeframe specified in the returns policy. The user navigates to the claim declaration section and selects the damage claim option. The user must provide the delivery reference number, the part number, the quantity affected, and a description of the damage. Photographic evidence of the damaged packaging and the damaged part itself is strongly recommended and may be required for claims above a certain value. Once submitted, the damage claim follows a similar review process to a warranty claim. If approved, the dealer will receive either a replacement part or a credit note depending on availability and preference.

2.6 Quantity Discrepancy Claims

If the quantity of parts received does not match the quantity on the delivery note or invoice, the dealer should raise a quantity discrepancy claim. This type of claim requires the delivery reference number and a clear statement of the quantity ordered, the quantity invoiced, and the quantity actually received. The claims team will investigate by checking warehouse dispatch records and carrier documentation. If the discrepancy is confirmed, a credit note or replacement shipment will be arranged. It is important to raise quantity discrepancy claims promptly, as investigations become more difficult over time.

2.7 Quarterly Return Process

The quarterly return process allows dealers to return a defined percentage of their net purchases from the previous quarter. The return window opens at the end of each quarter and remains open for a limited period. During this window, the dealer navigates to the quarterly return section of the portal and selects the parts they wish to return from their eligible purchase history. The system calculates the maximum returnable value based on the dealer purchase volume and the applicable return percentage. Parts must be in their original, undamaged packaging and must not have been installed. Once the return request is submitted, the dealer receives instructions for packaging and shipping the parts back to the warehouse. A credit note is issued once the returned parts have been received and inspected.

2.8 Yearly Return Process

The yearly return process follows a similar structure to the quarterly return but operates on an annual cycle and typically allows for a higher return value. The eligibility rules for yearly returns may differ from quarterly returns, and certain part categories may be excluded. Dealers are notified in advance of the yearly return window opening so they can prepare their return requests. The process for submitting, shipping, and receiving credit for yearly returns is the same as for quarterly returns.

2.9 Tracking Claim Status

At any point after a claim has been submitted, the dealer can check its current status through the claim tracking section of the portal. The system displays the claim reference number, the submission date, the current status, and any notes or requests from the claims processing team. Common statuses include submitted, under review, awaiting additional information, approved, rejected, and credit issued. Dealers are encouraged to monitor their claims regularly and respond promptly to any requests for additional information to avoid delays.

2.10 Credit Notes and Financial Adjustments

When a claim is approved, a credit note is generated and applied to the dealer account. The credit note details the original invoice reference, the claimed amount, and the approved credit value. Credit notes can be viewed and downloaded from the billing section of the portal. The credit is typically applied against future invoices, though the specific financial handling depends on the terms agreed in the dealer contract.